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Hiring Committee
Global Poverty Research Lab
Kellogg School of Management
Northwestern University
Evanston, Illinois

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the Research Analyst – Evidence Aggregation and Data Science position with the Global Poverty Research Lab at Northwestern University. I am currently an M.S. candidate in Statistical Science at Indiana University Bloomington, where I have developed a strong foundation in quantitative methods, reproducible research, and high-performance data workflows. This role aligns closely with my interests in evidence synthesis, policy-relevant research, and AI-assisted data infrastructure for development economics.

My recent research experience has given me hands-on exposure to structured data workflows, computational statistics, and rigorous validation. As a Research Assistant in the StatMIND Lab, I develop efficient C++ implementations through Rcpp and RcppArmadillo for high-dimensional neuroimaging analyses, reproduce original model outputs, and validate results using unit tests and benchmarking. This work has required careful attention to data integrity, reproducibility, and computational efficiency, and it has strengthened my ability to build reliable research pipelines for complex quantitative projects. I also developed benchmarking workflows to compare runtime and scalability across implementations, which improved performance and supported reproducible evaluation of computational methods.

In addition to my computational work, I have experience in statistical teaching and mentoring through my role as a Teaching Assistant in the Department of Statistics. I support undergraduate students in understanding stochastic reasoning, methodology, and computational interpretation, and I provide detailed feedback on assignments and discussion-based problem solving. This has strengthened my communication, organization, and collaborative skills in fast-paced academic settings.

My training in statistical modeling, Bayesian methods, and predictive analytics has prepared me to contribute meaningfully to a project centered on evidence aggregation, microdata harmonization, and cross-study analysis. I am especially interested in the Lab's focus on creating scalable systems that make rigorous evidence more accessible to researchers, policymakers, and practitioners. I am comfortable working in R, Python, SQL, Git, and Bash, and I am eager to expand my skills in collaborative data infrastructure, documentation, and validation workflows that support high-quality research outputs.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to GPRL's mission by combining my statistical training, programming experience, and commitment to rigorous, transparent research. Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to the possibility of discussing how my background and interests could support the Lab's work.

Sincerely,

Nahid Hasan Sagar